

IN THE SERVICE OF PEOPLE

| Amanbir Kaur Brar/Nishant Prabhakar |

THE Congress government with Mr Bhupinder Singh Hooda as the Chief Minister is back in power in Haryana to take the state into a new dawn of progress. During his second term, the government is as committed as ever to serve the people of the state in the best possible way. In its previous term, Haryana touched new heights of growth in different spheres - agriculture, power, industry, irrigation, education, health, rural and urban development, social welfare and women and child development. This time also, the government is committed to developing all sectors. The welfare of the common man is its top priority.

Agriculture and Farmers

Agriculture, the backbone of Haryana's economy, contributes 26.4 per cent to the state's GDP and 70 per cent of the population depends on it. The government reiterates its commitment to the welfare of the farming community. The government is committed to achieving the agricultural growth rate from 2 to 4 per cent in the coming five years. Farmers will be given 50 per cent subsidy on the purchase of specified farm machinery. With a view to conserving water, farmers will be paid 50 to 90 per cent subsidy on the use of sprinkler sets, drip irrigation and laying underground pipes. To encourage the farmers to grow sugarcane, Rs 2,000 subsidy will be given on the purchase of sugarcane seeds per acre. Haryana is giving the highest sugarcane price of Rs 185 per quintal to farmers besides Rs 25 per quintal as bonus.

Horticulture

The government is giving priority to promoting and developing horticulture. Israel being the leader in horticulture, a tie-up will be forged with it to learn new techniques of growing vegetables and fruits. A centre for experimentation in fruits will be opened at Sirsa, and one for vegetables at Karnal. A terminal market will be established at Ghanaur at the cost of Rs 1,500 crore. It will include cool chambers, chambers to ripen fruits, and for categorisation, screening and canning of vegetables to protect them from getting stale.

Animal Husbandary

In Haryana, the per capita availability of milk is the highest in the country. Milk production will be doubled in the next 10 years. With a view to giving a boost to animal husbandry, an independent Animal Medical and Animal Science University will be set up to boost quality animal production. The Murrah cattle breed will be further developed. The Murrah semen is in great demand, especially in southern states.

Co-operation

On the pattern of the Central loan waiver scheme, the state cooperative banks will also waive loans of landless, craftsmen, jewellers, shoemakers, artisans, weavers, small shopkeepers, barbers and blacksmiths. Under the scheme, a loan of Rs 10,000 will be waived on the condition that the loanee settles the amount over and above Rs 10,000 on that day. The scheme will benefit about 3.6 lakh non-farmer loanees. A total of Rs 285 crore in principal amount and interest of Rs 115 crore will be waived under the scheme. Members of Cooperative Credit Structure will also be covered under a health insurance scheme.

Irrigation

The Congress will make every effort to get the stay on linking of the Hansi-Butana Link Canal with the BML Canal vacated. Keeping the interests of Haryana in view, the government will enter into a new Renuka Dam waters agreement. The construction of the NCR water supply channel worth Rs 322

crore will be completed by March 2010 to meet the additional demand for water to Gurgaon, Bahadurgarh, Sampla, Badli and Manesar. A sum of Rs 100 crore will be spent on the maintenance and repair of 1,000 ponds in villages under the joint scheme of the Irrigation Department and CADDA. Every effort will be made to conserve water in the state, particularly rain and run-off water.

Power

The government wants to make Haryana a power surplus state by 2012. The government targets the production of an additional 5,000 MW of power for which it has set up four plants. While generation from the power plant at Yamunanagar has already started, the others will be commissioned within the stipulated time. To strengthen the power distribution system, old electricity cables, poles and transformers will be replaced in the coming five years. A sum of Rs 40,000 crore has been allocated for power generation, distribution and transmission during the 12th Five Year Plan. Haryana's first nuclear power plant will come up at Garakhpur in Fatehabad district for which the site has already been approved by the Nuclear Power Corporation of India on which Rs 24,000 crore would be spent.

Education

The Indian Institute of Management, Indian Institute of Information

